INTER-AGENCY COORDINATION · APRIL 2027

Coastal Flood Response

Standing up a joint command for the Bayshore levee district before the autumn storm season.

The ask: agree a single joint command and a shared funding split by 1 June.

Four agencies hold pieces of the Bayshore flood response and none holds the whole. We propose a standing joint command with one incident commander, a pooled $46M readiness fund, and signed roles before storm season opens.

Last autumn's response failed on coordination, not capability.

When the King Tide breached the Bayshore levee in November, three agencies deployed pumps to the same district while a fourth waited on an authorisation that never came. The after-action review found no single commander and no shared funding authority.

Each agency owns a piece; no one owns the outcome.

The levees, the pumps, the evacuation order, and the recovery funds sit in four different agencies under three different statutes. The gap is not resources — it is the absence of a structure that makes one person accountable for the whole response.

Who owns what under the proposed joint command.

Incident command & levee operations — Water District

Single incident commander; owns levee monitoring, breach response, and pump deployment.

Evacuation & public warning — Emergency Mgmt

Issues evacuation orders and runs the public alert system on the commander's call.

Funding & procurement — Finance Office

Holds the pooled readiness fund and pre-authorises emergency procurement.

Recovery & infrastructure — Public Works

Leads post-event debris, road, and levee repair under a standing contract.

The supporting roles the command draws on during an activation.

Forecasting & triggers — Met Service

Provides the tidal and rainfall forecasts that trigger each readiness level.

Health & shelter — Public Health

Stands up shelters and medical points once an evacuation is ordered.

Legal authority — County Counsel

Confirms the statutory basis for orders issued under emergency activation.

What each workstream delivers before storm season.

WORKSTREAM	CHARTER	DRILL	READY
	APRIL	JUNE	SEPTEMBER
Command structure	✓ Roles agreed	− Tabletop	○ Activation drill
Funding pool	− $46M committed	○ Pre-auth	○ Draw-down tested
Joint operations	○ Comms plan	− Cache sited	○ Pumps sited
Public warning	✓ Alerts linked	− Routes set	○ Community drill

✓ Shipped − In flight ○ Planned

Where each agency stands on stand-up commitments.

WORKSTREAM	CHARTER · APRIL	DRILL · JUNE	READY · SEPTEMBER
Water District	✓ Commander set	− Pump ready	○ Breach drill
Emergency Mgmt	✓ Alert linkage	− Routes mapped	○ Evac exercise
Finance Office	− Fund committed	○ Pre-authorized	○ Draw-down test
Public Works	✓ Standing contract	⁄ ~~Debris site~~	○ Repair drill

✓ Shipped − In flight ○ Planned ⁄ Out of scope

The pooled fund is the part that needs a decision today.

The command structure can be chartered administratively, but the $46M readiness fund requires each agency to commit its share into a single pooled account with pre-authorised draw-down. Without that, the next response repeats last autumn's funding stall. This is the item we need agreed in the room.

Charter the joint command and pool the readiness fund before 1 June.

CHARTER THE JOINT COMMAND

Puts one accountable commander over the whole response, closing last year's gap.

WHY NOT KEEP FOUR MANDATES

The after-action review traced the breach failure directly to divided command.

WHY NOT DELAY TO NEXT CYCLE

A delayed charter misses the September drill and the next storm season.

JOINT FLOOD TASK FORCE · FLOODRESPONSE.GOV.EXAMPLE

One command, one fund, ready before the water rises.